SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

WEEDING AND DESELECTION PRACTICES: STRATEGIES AND CHALLENGES OF ACADEMIC LIBRARIES IN CARAGA REGION

A Thesis Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Computing and Information Sciences

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BACHELOR OF LIBRARY AND INFORMATION SCIENCE

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SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
College Of Computing and Information Sciences

CERTIFICATE OF RESEARCH APPROVAL

This thesis entitled **"**Weeding and Deselection Practices: Strategies and Challenges in Academic Libraries in Caraga Region**"** presented and submitted by Click here to enter text. in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of Bachelor of Library and Information Science is hereby accepted and recommended for Oral Examination.

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ABSTRACT

TITLE:	Weeding And Deselection Practices: Strategies and Challenges in Academic Libraries in Caraga Region
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EXPLANATORY SEQUENTIAL MIXED-METHOD RESEARCH DESIGN

I. OBJECTIVES

For the effective collection management in academic libraries, this study will examine the strategies adopted by academic libraries in the Caraga Region for weeding and deselection. Particular emphasis is placed on the influence of the Collection Development Policy and the distinct responsibilities of librarians and faculty members in the process. The study further considers various approaches to improving the weeding process, such as data-driven decision-making, fostering collaboration, implementing sustainable practices, and integrating technological solutions. Furthermore, the research will identify and assess key challenges, including limited budgets, physical space constraints, and staff resistance, each with significant implications for weeding and deselection activities.

II. METHODOLOGY

To examine the weeding and deselection in academic libraries in Caraga Region, this study will employ an Explanatory Sequential Mixed-Method research design. The investigation will involve twenty-seven (27) academic libraries: nineteen (19) from private institutions and eight (8) from public institutions. These respondents account for 70.37% of private libraries and 29.63% of public libraries. In each case, a librarian or faculty member will be selected to participate as a respondent. Given the considerable distance between these libraries, data will be collected via an electronic questionnaire distributed via Google Forms. The instrument for data collection will consist of a structured questionnaire incorporating Likert-scale items designed to assess the degree to which various strategies, such as data-driven weeding, collaborative approaches, sustainability initiatives, and the integration of technology, are implemented within these libraries. Furthermore, the questionnaire will address prevailing challenges through respondents' open-ended responses.**III. FINDINGS**

IV. RECOMMENDATIONS

KEYWORDS: WEEDING AND DESELECTION, COLLECTION DEVELOPMENT POLICY, STRATEGIES, CARAGA REGION, CHALLENGES

DEDICATION

This study is dedicated to the researchers' beloved families, whose unwavering love, sacrifices, and constant encouragement have been the foundation of this journey. Their patience, understanding, and belief in the researchers have provided the strength to persevere through the most challenging moments, making every achievement meaningful.

To the researchers' mentors and instructors, whose guidance, wisdom, and expertise have been necessary in shaping this study. Your insightful feedback and encouragement have not only enhanced the quality of this work but have also inspired a deeper understanding of the research process.

To the researchers' friends and peers, whose support, motivation, and friendship have made this journey more enjoyable and less daunting. Whether through shared laughter, helpful advice, or just being there when needed most, your presence has been a true blessing.

To all those who have contributed, directly or indirectly, to this study, the researchers are deeply grateful for your influence and assistance in bringing this work to completion.

Above all, this study is dedicated to Almighty God for His divine guidance, grace, and strength, which have made this achievement possible. Without His endless wisdom and blessings, none of this would have been achievable.



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Lastly, the researchers wish to thank all those who, in one way or another, have contributed to the success of this study. Your support and encouragement have not gone unnoticed.

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

In academic libraries, managing information resources is key to maintaining a high-quality collection (Nelson et al., 2020a; OSLA, 2023). The main components of collection management is weeding (Wong, 2025a). Weeding is also referred to as “retirement, pruning, reverse selection, deselection, exclusion, and discarding” (Wadje & Sable, 2022, p.86), Similarly, Griffin and Bergquist (2019) stated that “weeding” and “deselection” are the terms often used interchangeably by librarians. “Deselection and weeding are used synonymously, but 'weeding' is the more popular term,” to describe the process of removing library resources that no longer contribute to the health of the collection (p.5).

While the terminology may vary, both refer to the same essential practice of removing materials that no longer meet the needs of the library’s users (Soni et al., 2024). Also, it is the process of choosing and removing old, damaged, or unused items from the library's collection (Sathe & Kala Mahavidyalaya, 2023) and a critical component of quality management because they help make space for new materials, as libraries need new acquisitions to support the academic community's growing needs (Delgado, 2021; Nelson et al., 2020b). This type of process is essential to enhance the relevance and quality of library collections (Johnson, 2004, as cited in Galbraith, 2019).

However, it is necessary to understand that weeding involves more than removing items from the collection; it is a purposeful and systemic process (Management of Library and Information Centre, 2024). Effective management requires that weeding policies be clearly stated in writing, which holds significant importance in a library's Collection Development Policy (Sagar, 2022). Furthermore, Armanul and the authors (2023) addressed the Collection Development

Policy as a systematic approach to managing reasons for weeding, reducing uncertainty, and increasing efficiency.

Also, librarians collaborating with faculty members can contribute to better decision-making when it comes to weeding. When faculty actively take part, they can adopt a more comprehensive approach to weeding, as they are knowledgeable about their students' needs and academic programs (Kaur et al., 2024). Additionally, Laure (2024) studied fourteen (14) libraries across Region 10 in Mindanao and emphasized the importance of having a Collection Development Policy (CDP) to maintain collection quality.

On the other hand, the MUSTIE criteria (Misleading, Ugly, Superseded, Trivial, Irrelevant, and Easily obtained elsewhere) serve as helpful guidelines for librarians in identifying materials to weed out (Adindu et al., 2022). Also, Hieb & Seldin (2022) supported the use of data-driven methods as a practical approach to addressing some of these considerations. Data-driven weeding enables librarians to analyze how frequently users use materials and identify which materials to deselect (Broadbent et al., 2022).

However, Dioneda (2024) noted that although libraries in the Philippines recognize collection maintenance, including weeding, as crucial, they often face inconsistent weeding practices and lack formal processes due to budget constraints. With this gap, libraries struggle to meet the current needs of users, resulting in outdated collections (Kamau & Elegwa, 2022a; Mercedez & Haz, 2025). Moreover, budget constraints, space limitations, and staff resistance are common challenges that obstruct systematic weeding practices (Meena, 2024). These issues create inefficiencies in collection management, further complicating efforts to maintain relevant and current resources (Banda 2020).

In light of this, the main goal of this study is to see how academic libraries in the Caraga region manage weeding and deselection practices. This aim includes examining their collection

development policy and the involvement of librarians and faculty members, and the academic library profile, which encompasses factors such as the library's population, collection size, and the weeding frequency. Understanding these elements will provide context for how weeding and deselection practices are implemented across different library settings. Additionally, the study will explore the strategies, such as data-driven weeding, collaborative weeding, sustainability, and technology integration. Furthermore, this study will examine the challenges faced by academic libraries, including budget constraints, limited space, and staff resistance.

The findings from this study will be valuable for various stakeholders, including school administrators, librarians, faculty members, and library users. Administrators can use the results to support libraries by improving physical spaces, enhancing library facilities, and upgrading resources. School librarians can benefit from practical recommendations for weeding out their collections, resulting in more organized, up-to-date library holdings. Faculty members will gain access to collections that better align with their teaching or research requirements. Library users will have access to the most relevant and up-to-date materials, enhancing their experience.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

In academic libraries, weeding and deselection are crucial processes that ensure the ongoing relevance and quality of a library's collection. These practices involve systematically removing outdated, damaged, or underused materials to make room for new acquisitions that better serve users' evolving needs (Johnson, 2013, as cite in Goulding, 2025).

Understanding how libraries implement these processes requires examining the various factors that influence their decision-making. This chapter reviews the literature surrounding the academic library profile, weeding and deselection practices, which are interconnected and essential in shaping how libraries manage their collections (Rowley & Willson, 2022). Variables such as collection size, user population, and weeding frequency are important for assessing the implementation of weeding and deselection in academic libraries in the Caraga Region. Furthermore, collection development policies (CDP) and the involvement of librarians and faculty are key elements in guiding weeding decisions and ensuring that the process aligns with the institution's academic goals (Ashilungu & Onyancha, 2024a).

Key strategies like data-driven weeding, collaborative weeding, sustainability, and technology integration help libraries optimize their collection management practices. However, academic libraries also face several challenges, including budget constraints, space limitations, and staff resistance, which affect the effectiveness of the weeding process (Meena & Lib, 2024b).

The following sections will explore each of these variables in greater detail, discussing how they contribute to or hinder the effectiveness of weeding and deselection practices in academic libraries.

Academic Library Profile

User Population

User population is a crucial factor relevant to weeding and deselection as it provides insight into how the library's collection is being used by its patrons, which directly informs decisions about which materials to retain, replace, or remove (Eknathrao et al., 2022). By analyzing the user population, libraries can track usage patterns such as circulation rates, digital access, and user preferences (Kim et al., 2020). This data helps identify which resources actively support the users' academic and informational needs and which resources have become obsolete or are rarely used (Stites et al., 2019). A growing or diverse user population may demand more frequent and targeted weeding to keep the collection relevant and manageable, while a smaller or specialized user base might require a highly curated collection focusing on niche materials (Phugnar et al., 2022).

Ignoring user population data can lead to collections cluttered with outdated and unnecessary materials, wasting valuable shelf space (Meena & Lib, 2024c). User population information allows libraries to adapt their collections dynamically, ensuring they provide materials that are both useful and accessible(Bryan, 2025). Reflecting the user population's needs in weeding practices enhances user satisfaction, engagement, and the library's overall effectiveness in supporting research and learning (Broadbent et al., 2022). It fosters a user-centered approach where collection development and maintenance are directly responsive to known community demands (Nelson et al., 2020b). This relevance makes user population an indispensable variable in evidence-based collection management, optimizing resource allocation, and ensuring that deselection processes contribute to vibrant, functional, and respected academic libraries (Meena & Lib, 2024b).

Collection Size

An appropriate collection size is critical to maintaining an effective and relevant academic library. If a collection becomes overcrowded with outdated or unused materials, access, organization, and space will suffer. Weeding and deselection of library materials help librarians ensure that items are kept useful, current, and reflective of users' needs. Weeding and deselection also help maintain a manageable collection size and increase the effective use of space. Each contributes to the library's role as a support to teaching and research. The Philippines' Commission on Higher Education (CHED) indicated in its (CMO No. 22, 2021) that the requirements for library collections are 3,000 titles for new higher education institutions and 5,000 titles for pre-existing higher education institutions. CMO No. 22 relates to the necessity to review and weed library collections. Regular reviews provide an opportunity to weed out and ensure that library collections are relevant and of quality. CMO No. 22 outlines procedures for assessing collections while underscoring the importance of assessment for weeding and deselection, both of which are essential to the development of a library collection in college and university libraries. It establishes a process for ongoing assessment of collections and their role in weeding and deselecting materials, which are critical to effective collection development in academic libraries.

Levine-Clark (2019) emphasized that the academic library of the future must maintain a balanced and right-sized collection that adapts to technological and scholarly changes. Similarly, (Pope, 2022) noted that rightsizing ensures the library's resources remain current, purposeful, and responsive to user demand. Both authors highlight that regulating collection size through weeding and deselection is vital for long-term sustainability. McAllister (2022)pointed out that organized rightsizing initiatives guide librarians in applying systematic deselection to preserve accessibility and relevance. In the same context, Miller and the authors (2022) emphasized that careful

downsizing through rightsizing not only eliminates unused materials but also supports the renewal and modernization of academic collections.

(Proctor, 2021) presented a collaborative rightsizing project where an academic library effectively addressed space shortages by removing outdated materials and improving shelf organization. Likewise, (Gladis & Wiggins, 2024) explained that a university library's transformation through rightsizing resolved overcrowding and enhanced access to materials, demonstrating that collection-size management directly contributes to improved library services. These studies confirm that an adequate collection size, achieved through weeding and deselection, is an important component of collection management.

Weeding Frequency

Moreover, weeding frequency refers to the regular systematic review of their collections to identify outdated, damaged, or rarely used materials and remove or replace them (Phugnar et al., 2022). Establishing a consistent weeding is vital to maintaining the health and relevance of the library's collection, preventing the accumulation of obsolete resources that could hinder user access and satisfaction (Datti, 2020). As stated in CHED Memorandum Order No. 22, Series of 2021, "regular weeding or deselection program shall be undertaken to keep the collections of print and electronic relevant and up-to-date." (Standards for Academic Libraries in the Philippines (SALP), 2025, section 4, no. 6). Libraries often adopt pre-planned schedules for weeding, ranging from continuous ongoing reviews to biannual or annual cycles, to ensure that the collection remains responsive to the evolving needs of their user communities (Rowley & Willson, 2022).

Weeding frequency supports space optimization, allowing libraries to accommodate new acquisitions without overcrowding shelving or storage areas, which is especially critical in institutions with limited physical space (Sathe & Mahavidyalaya, 2023b). Furthermore, maintaining a suitable frequency of weeding enables libraries to use their budgets more efficiently by

prioritizing the acquisition of relevant, current materials instead of investing in preserving underused items (Patil & Salwe, 2020). Advances in library analytics and automated tools have facilitated data-driven approaches to determining optimal weeding frequency by monitoring circulation statistics, material condition, and other key metrics, leading to more evidence-based, targeted deselection processes (Aguiñaga & McKennon, 2025).

Regular weeding is particularly important for larger libraries that need to manage extensive collections and ensure that space constraints do not interfere with the addition of new materials (Gregory, 2011, as cited in Lantzy et al., 2020). Conversely, smaller libraries might not need to weed as frequently. However, when they do, the process is often more focused and targeted, addressing specific areas of the collection that no longer serve the community. It is understandable, especially if the library only has a small collection size, that weeding can be difficult to implement regularly (Horvath et al., 2025).

The weeding frequency thus reflects the library's ability to assess and manage its collection in a timely and efficient manner, influenced by its resources and organizational structures (Lantzy et al., 2020).

Weeding and Deselection Practices

Collection Development Policy

A collection development policy serves as a fundamental framework that guides the systematic selection, acquisition, evaluation, and withdrawal of materials in academic libraries, ensuring that resources remain relevant, current, and aligned with institutional missions (Etuk & Adeyoyin, 2021). It serves as a blueprint that guides all aspects of collection management, ensuring transparency, accountability, and consistent decision-making. According to (HUSSAINI, 2020) the management of collection development policies in libraries is often challenged by

inadequate funding, limited infrastructure, and insufficient staff training, which hinder the consistent application of selection and deselection standards. Libraries that lack clear policy guidelines frequently face problems such as duplication, gaps in subject coverage, and the accumulation of obsolete materials. Similarly, Khan and Bhatti (2021) found that most university libraries in Pakistan lack comprehensive collection development and management policies, resulting in imbalanced and outdated collections. Their study emphasized that well-documented policies strengthen transparency and rational decision-making by defining clear procedures for both acquisitions and weeding, thus ensuring that library collections support institutional curricula and research priorities.

The integration of technology has further reshaped the way collection development policies are designed and implemented. (Mallick, 2020) observed that the use of information and communication technology (ICT) tools has transformed the process of collection building by introducing data analytics, automated systems, and electronic resource management platforms. These innovations enable librarians to make evidence-based decisions using usage statistics, circulation patterns, and citation analysis, enhancing both the precision and efficiency of selection and deselection. ICT applications also support the creation of user-driven collections, ensuring that acquisitions reflect actual information needs rather than traditional assumptions about relevance. The study highlighted that the effective implementation of such policies requires librarians to possess strong technological competencies and to engage in continuous professional development.

In addition, emerging trends emphasize the value of inclusive and participatory collection development policies that reflect the diversity of academic communities. Boldt and researchers (2024), in their study at the University of Massachusetts, argued that democratizing the collection development process through collaboration among librarians, administrators, and stakeholders

fosters greater accountability and responsiveness to institutional goals. Their findings suggested that shared governance models create more equitable and representative collections that address both mainstream and marginalized perspectives within academia. Similarly, Makula and Turner (2022) advocated for community-engaged and socially responsive collection development practices that extend beyond institutional boundaries. Their work emphasized inclusivity and knowledge equity by promoting the incorporation of locally produced materials and indigenous scholarship, thereby reinforcing libraries' role as active agents of knowledge inclusivity in higher education.

The relationship between a well-formulated collection development policy and effective weeding or deselection practices has also been widely discussed in recent research. Broadbent and researchers (2022) highlighted that structured collaboration and clear policy guidelines during weeding projects enhance communication, reduce conflict, and ensure that deselection aligns with academic program requirements. Their study found that when weeding decisions are guided by policy and shared criteria, they lead to better space management, improved accessibility, and higher-quality collections that genuinely serve user needs. Building on this, (Loving, 2025) presented a case study at Southwestern Oklahoma State University showing that revising outdated deselection policies and adopting the Continuous Review, Evaluation, and Weeding (CREW) method significantly improved transparency and efficiency in collection maintenance. The adoption of such structured frameworks empowered librarians to make informed choices, balancing preservation with the need for renewal and relevance.

Finally, Ashilungu and Onyancha (2024) examined collection development strategies at the University of Namibia, focusing on the effectiveness of policies for managing electronic resources. Their study revealed that consistent policy application and evaluation ensure that digital collections remain current, accessible, and responsive to user demand. They stressed that

strong policy foundations contribute to optimizing limited budgets and enhancing service delivery. Collectively, these studies affirm that an effective collection development policy is indispensable to the vitality of academic libraries. It not only provides a roadmap for the acquisition and deselection of materials but also ensures that library collections evolve in tandem with institutional goals, technological changes, and user expectations.

Librarians and Faculty Involvement

The role of academic faculty in the deselection process is essential within academic libraries. While librarians often apply specific criteria for weeding, these may differ from the criteria used by faculty. The authors highlighted that combining the expertise and knowledge of both librarians and faculty ensures the library collection remains responsive to curricular and research needs. Furthermore, a collaborative approach to weeding, helps librarians enhance their understanding of the collection by integrating perspectives from faculty outside the library (Reed & Li, 2020). In recent years, this relationship has expanded beyond the traditional confines of collection management and reference services, evolving into a more dynamic and integrated approach that encompasses shared responsibilities in teaching, research, and digital scholarship. Librarians are increasingly acknowledged not only as custodians of recorded knowledge but also as academic partners who actively participate in the design, implementation, and evaluation of educational and research initiatives alongside faculty members. This evolution signifies a wider transformation in the function of academic libraries, shifting from primarily service-oriented entities to becoming integral contributors to the learning and research missions of universities.

Recent studies highlight the multifaceted nature of librarian–faculty collaboration and its significant impact on institutional outcomes. Blankstein (2022), through the *Ithaka S+R U.S. faculty Survey*, found that faculty increasingly perceive librarians as essential collaborators in supporting both student learning and scholarly productivity. Their nationwide data demonstrated that

libraries play a central role in research data management, digital scholarship, and information literacy integration, emphasizing that frequent communication and co-instructional planning between librarians and faculty enhance course design and improve student research performance. The findings suggest that sustained partnerships lead to stronger curricular alignment, more effective use of library resources, and an expanded understanding of the library as a core component of the academic mission.

Complementing this perspective, Beaubien and researchers (2022) discovered that collaboration between faculty and librarians in virtual classrooms substantially enhances students' information literacy and research engagement. Their study revealed that when librarians participate in curriculum development and assessment, they are able to tailor instructional content to disciplinary needs and provide targeted support that aligns with course outcomes. This model of embedded partnership underscores the growing pedagogical role of librarians as co-educators who contribute directly to student learning rather than functioning solely as information providers. Similarly, (Andrikopoulou et al., 2022) examined the evolving professional identity of academic librarians through their participation in research data management (RDM) initiatives. The authors found that collaboration in RDM activities not only strengthens relationships between librarians and faculty but also redefines librarians' roles as data stewards, research advisors, and co-producers of scholarly knowledge. Such partnerships enhance institutional research capacity and encourage the development of innovative, evidence-based library services that respond to the complex data needs of modern academia.

Beyond library-specific studies, research in other fields reinforces the importance of collaborative engagement as a driver of innovation and inclusivity. (Boden and researchers (2021), in their examination of meaningful engagement in synthesis reviews, emphasized that trust, respect, and shared decision-making are fundamental to successful academic partnerships.

Although their study focused on patient-oriented research, its findings parallel the principles underlying effective librarian–faculty collaboration—both rely on reciprocal learning, transparent communication, and the recognition of each partner's expertise. Similarly, Colomer-Lahiguera and colleagues 2023) investigated participatory collaboration in cancer research and found that co-created approaches foster a sense of shared ownership and lead to more impactful outcomes. Translating these insights into the academic library context, it becomes clear that inclusive and participatory relationships between librarians and faculty contribute to equitable knowledge production, improved curriculum design, and sustainable institutional development.

Contemporary librarian–faculty collaborations also demonstrate the value of co-instructional and research-based engagement in improving student outcomes and research literacy. (Redekop & Hobbs, 2025) provided compelling evidence through their case study on academic writing instruction at Case Western Reserve University, where faculty and librarians jointly designed and delivered course content. Their results showed that such partnerships lead to deeper student engagement with scholarly sources, improved citation practices, and stronger critical thinking skills. The study highlighted that active, team-based collaboration allows faculty to draw upon librarians' specialized expertise in Collectively, these studies underscore the essential role of librarian–faculty collaboration in achieving academic success, especially within the rapidly changing landscape of information technology, research methodologies, and educational practices. Through ongoing and purposeful collaboration, librarians and faculty members are able to enrich the academic experiences of students while simultaneously strengthening the institution's capacity for effective curriculum development, research management, and the dissemination of knowledge.

Within the context of academic libraries in the Caraga Region, the reinforcement of librarian–faculty partnerships are particularly important in addressing enduring challenges such

as inadequate funding, technological gaps, and varying degrees of information literacy among faculty. By promoting active cooperation in areas such as collection development, weeding, research support, and instructional activities, libraries can better adapt to evolving academic requirements and ensure that their resources and services continue to advance the institution's mission. Ultimately, sustained collaboration forms the bedrock upon which adaptive, innovative, and inclusive academic libraries are built, ensuring that they remain responsive to the needs and aspirations of their academic communities' resources and services continue to support institutional excellence. Sustained collaboration thus serves as the foundation for building adaptive, innovative, and inclusive academic libraries that truly reflect the needs and aspirations of their academic communities.

Weeding and Deselection Strategies

Collaborative Weeding

The process of collaborative weeding occupies a central position in the effective management and delivery of weeding and deselection activities within libraries. By fostering teamwork, open communication, and the pursuit of shared objectives, collaborative approaches yield improved outcomes in the area of collection management. (McLain & McKelvey, 2022) observed, in the context of a large-scale initiative involving inventory, deselection, and the relocation of print materials to offsite storage, that meticulous planning, the empowerment of personnel, and robust communication among work groups are instrumental in facilitating smoother workflows and more informed decision-making. Their findings underscore the fact that interdepartmental collaboration enhances efficiency, accountability, and operational success, particularly in the context of extensive deselection projects.

In a similar vein, (Rowley & Willson, 2022) established that collaborative structures and shared governance exert a significant influence on weeding decisions within Scottish public libraries. Their research demonstrated that librarians routinely engage in consultation with colleagues, management, and central headquarters when determining which materials should be removed, thereby ensuring that the process is transparent, consistent, and aligned with the overarching goals of the organization. Such collaboration cultivates mutual awareness and trust among team members, while also enhancing the library's responsiveness to the needs of its community. In support of this perspective, Timms (2019)highlighted the importance of data-driven collaboration, utilizing tools such as the OCLC WorldCat Search API to integrate data usage with professional judgment. While technological tools contribute to efficiency, Timms maintained that authentic discussion and collective decision-making among professionals remain indispensable to achieving fairness and equity in weeding practices.

Further evidence in support of the collaborative approach is provided by Proctor (2021), who examined a weeding initiative at Penn State University Libraries in which faculty and librarians worked together, employing circulation data, holdings comparisons, and publication age as criteria for identifying outdated materials. The study concluded that trust, consensus, and flexibility are essential for achieving accuracy and minimizing conflict throughout the deselection process. In a similar context, Burke and Kilb (2019a) contended that ongoing communication and transparency among teams serve to enhance the efficiency of large-scale weeding projects. Collectively, these studies affirm that organizational collaboration, shared decision-making, and open communication among staff are fundamental to establishing a data-informed, equitable process for managing library collections.

Collaboration also extends beyond library staff to include faculty and other academic stakeholders. DeMars and researchers (2019) examined a large deselection project at California

State University, Fullerton, where faculty actively participated in evaluating materials using GreenGlass software and online feedback systems. This collaboration fostered greater transparency and trust between faculty and library staff, though it also lengthened the project timeline due to the additional consultation required. Expanding this idea, Hallam and researchers (2021a) found that collaborative engagement between faculty and librarians promotes open communication, shared decision-making, and flexibility in policy application. Their findings suggested that involving faculty helps reduce emotional resistance to deselection by reframing it as a collective, practical process rather than an emotional one, leading to more balanced and inclusive decisions.

Within a broader context, Olubiyo (2023) examined the challenges associated with collection development in Nigerian academic libraries, emphasizing that collaboration among library staff, faculty, and researchers is indispensable for the maintenance of sustainable and well-informed collections. The study further recommended the formulation of clear policies and the enhancement of open-access resources as means to support collaborative and sustainable weed management processes, particularly in institutions facing financial constraints. These findings underscore the centrality of institutional cooperation as the foundation for equitable and effective deselection practices.

Engelson (2019) provided a compelling illustration of the advantages of coordinated collaboration through a large-scale weeding project that successfully removed 100,000 volumes from a university library collection. The shared responsibility and open communication among departments contributed to increased efficiency, accuracy, and staff morale. In a similar manner, Swenson and colleagues (2024) emphasized the importance of collaboration during the withdrawal phase, demonstrating that coordination among technical services, cataloging, and

circulation units is essential for ensuring the smooth removal of materials and maintaining accountability.

Sustainability

Speaking of removal, removing items from the library collection and weeding are part of a sustainable practice, especially regarding the relevancy, accuracy and alignment of collections with institutional goals. As Dadpe and researchers (2022) said, a purposeful process of removing old or unused practices, to objectively engage with weak collections, keep users current in trends of their own community, and to keep a user-centered collection, is vital. The study defined criteria for weeding the collection which includes physical condition, currency of information, circulation reports, and by policy in which to define collections to democracy the whole collection. Supporting those claims, Phugnar and colleagues (2022) stated having an explicit policy of weeding is about principles of fairness and accountability, and allows for effort in reducing emotional biases. The authors expressed that an intentional systematic, and transparent deselection process entailed sustainability by redecorating the mission of the library and the community needs, with collection management practices and procedures.

Marquez (2024) extended this inquiry by examining the discarding practices of public libraries in the United States. Typically, weeding is followed by donating, selling, or returning weeded items to a vendor who has a resale contract, such as Better World Books or whatever other vendor. This is much the same as we described earlier with academic libraries weeding wisely with a sustainable weeding disposition option. Bull and Downey (2024) made similar points and noted that sustainable deselection means much more than weeding outdated publications but involves decision making that aligns with the institution's shared values to ecological responsibility, and maximizing an efficient space ratio. Siemensma and researchers (2022) agreed with Bull and referred to "rightsizing" as balanced, and data-informed, ethical approach that allows

libraries to make use of the space they have, recycle extra materials, and share library materials equitably across institutions. Altogether, these articles demonstrate that while weeding sustainably may take planning, purpose and ways to share responsibility and commitment to ongoing stewardship leads to sustainability.

Similarly to physical collections, sustainability is included in the processes concerning digital collections which also includes evaluation and revitalization. Chee (2020) refers to the fact that digital resources such as LibGuides must be evaluated continuously for accuracy, usability, and organization. Riermaier and colleagues (2021a) note that digital government information is no different, and users must establish systematic, rigorous review cycles and maintain ongoing accuracy of metadata about digital government information in order to maintain access and reliability. Hallam and researchers (2021b) stated that academic libraries must continuously develop and deselect collections as part of sustainable actions framed by collaboration, policy, and ongoing evaluation.

Importantly, the authors all infer that sustainability within both collections is a process and is not as simple as saying that the library has been weeded once, but rather that it is a result of continuously, and ethically, making data-informed decisions in the pursuit of maintaining library resources through sustainable viability over time.

Data-Driven Weeding

In the face of growing information resource complexity and persistent physical space constraints, academic libraries have increasingly adopted data-driven weeding to sustain collections that are both relevant and responsive to user needs. The integration of technology, usage statistics, and metadata into the deselection process enables librarians to make decisions that are grounded in evidence and aligned with the evolving priorities of the academic community.

By employing these methods, libraries are better positioned to maintain collections that are accurate, current, and reflective of institutional objectives.

According to Hieb and Seldin (2022) combining automated retention rules with professional judgment allows for effective and balanced weeding. Their study demonstrated that automation simplifies decision-making but that librarian expertise is still vital for fair and accurate outcomes. Similarly, Rhanoui and team (2022) introduced a smart data-enabled strategy using machine learning and recommender systems to analyze borrowing patterns and user preferences, ensuring that retention decisions are based on user relevance rather than circulation numbers alone. This shows how artificial intelligence and user analytics strengthen evidence-based librarianship. The implementation of large-scale data-driven weeding initiatives, such as those utilizing the OCLC-based tool GreenGlass at institutions including Villanova University and California State University, Fullerton, has further illustrated the capacity of automated systems to facilitate comprehensive analysis of circulation data and holdings. Through such tools, libraries have been able to engage in transparent collaboration with faculty members, resulting in the systematic removal of outdated materials. These experiences underscore the role of automation and data analytics in promoting both operational efficiency and cooperative decision-making within the broader framework of library management.

However, Broadbent and researchers (2022) emphasized that data accuracy remains crucial. Even advanced systems like GreenGlass depend on reliable metadata, and errors can lead to the loss of valuable materials. Thus, redundancy checks and librarian oversight remain essential to ensure balanced decisions. Likewise, (Hendley, 2019) found that while automation increases consistency, poor data quality can cause mistaken removals, reinforcing the need for professional review in automated processes.

In support of these observations, Vnuk (2022) has highlighted in The Weeding Handbook that the application of evidence-based weeding methods, including statistical analysis and the use of integrated library system reports, provides a foundation for objective evaluation and the ongoing revitalization of library collections. Consequently, the process of weeding ought to be regarded not as a destructive measure, but rather as a constructive endeavor that enhances accessibility, fosters growth, and creates intellectual space for the benefit of the user community.

In summary, the integration of data-driven approaches within the weeding process represents a synthesis of technological innovation and professional expertise, thereby enabling libraries to pursue efficient, accurate, and responsible management of their collections. By combining automation, analytical tools, and the informed judgment of librarians, institutions are able to ensure that their collections remain dynamic, relevant, and closely aligned with the overarching goals of the organization.

Technology Integration

Recognizing the pivotal role that technology now plays in the effective management of library collections, it is evident that the integration of emerging tools and systems has become essential for improving the accuracy, efficiency, and sustainability of weeding and deselection practices. As Roberts and Florentine (2024) have noted, the use of artificial intelligence, computer vision, and automated detection tools not only increases precision but also reduces the manual labour traditionally associated with collection management. The adoption of digital tools, analytics, and management systems within libraries reflects a broader trend seen across various sectors. For example, Kaur and colleagues (2024) have shown that the application of precision agriculture, genomic techniques, and robotic weed control has greatly enhanced weed management and sustainability in agriculture. These advancements highlight the potential of automation and data-driven approaches to improve operational efficiency and support more

informed decision-making. In a similar manner, Kumbo and researchers (2023) have observed that the introduction of digital learning tools, online platforms, and virtual classrooms has transformed educational practices, promoting collaboration and critical thinking, though challenges such as the digital divide remain.

Furthermore, Akcil and researchers (2021) have highlighted the importance of the Technological Pedagogical Content Knowledge (TPACK) framework. Within the context of library management, the integration of technology has brought about significant changes in the processes of collection management and maintenance. Riermaier and team (2021b) have observed that librarians now employ tools such as link validators and the PURL Usage Reporting Tool to identify broken links and monitor resource usage, thereby ensuring that collections remain accessible and relevant to users. In a similar vein, Olubiyo (2023) has emphasized the role of technology in enabling librarians to evaluate, organize, and make available digital materials within repositories and open-access platforms, thus enhancing both accessibility and discoverability. In support of these developments, Burke and the authors (2021) have demonstrated the use of GreenGlass software and Python scripts to automate the deselection process, which facilitates efficient, accurate, and evidence-based decision-making in collection management and exposes digital materials in repositories.

In summary, the integration of technology serves to reinforce the effectiveness of library operations by bringing together automation, analytics, and the professional expertise of librarians. As evidenced by advancements in agriculture, education, and librarianship, the considered application of technological tools promotes innovation, accuracy, and sustainability. In this way, academic libraries are better equipped to maintain collections that are not only efficient and relevant but also responsive to their users' needs. The use of technology fosters innovation, accuracy, and sustainability, ensuring that academic libraries maintain collections that are efficient,

relevant, and user-centered (Burke et al., 2021; Riermaier et al., 2021b; Roberts & Florentine, 2024)

Weeding and Deselection Challenges

Budget Constraints

The difficulties in managing library collections in the face of budget constraints are a complex problem that calls for certain approaches to guarantee that libraries can keep operating at their best. Budget constraints also impact library digitization efforts. As technology develops, libraries should implement digital systems that make information easier for patrons to access. Users can access reading materials online without physically visiting the library thanks to a digital library system. However, putting such a system into place necessitates a large financial outlay, which includes buying computers and servers, software for managing digital collections, and training librarians to use the system efficiently (Winastwan & Fatwa, 2021)

The budget of the library also play a critical role in determining weeding frequency, as libraries with limited funds or personnel may only be able to conduct weeding on a less frequent or as-needed basis (Shivakumaraswamy, 2019). Budgetary constraints also affect library operations, including staff welfare and facility maintenance. Certain libraries find it difficult to offer support that enhance patron comfort when accessing collections, such as comfortable reading areas and sufficient air conditioning (Maknun et al., 2021). Due to tight funds, librarians frequently receive uncompetitive pay and benefits, which discourage individuals from pursuing jobs in the library industry. However, librarians have a critical role in collection management, user services, and the creation of creative literacy initiatives (Helmy & Trisyanti, 2020)

Budget constraints have an impact on both printed and digital collections, which are becoming more and more important in the current digital era. According to Helmy and Trisyanti (2020), the high expenses associated with digitizing collections provide significant obstacles for

many libraries. Libraries must take creative and sustainable approaches to collection expansion if they are to overcome the ongoing difficulties brought on by tight finances. Forming cooperative partnerships with different stakeholders, especially those outside the conventional public funding structure, is one of the most promising approaches.

Collection management presents additional issues for libraries that serve user groups with particular needs. There are still very few accessible reading materials available for students with disabilities, and current funding is not enough to create inclusive collections that can accommodate all kinds of disabilities (Maknun et al., 2021). This emphasizes that serving the various requirements of patrons is just as important to library management as keeping up book holdings. However, libraries also have trouble holding onto skilled staff members. The limited updating of library collections is one of the main impacts of budget constraints.

Whether for public or academic purposes, libraries are in charge of supplying users with current and relevant materials to meet their needs. However, many libraries, especially those in underfunded areas, are unable to subscribe to digital databases and scientific journals or buy recently released books (Acheson, 2024).

In the context of libraries in developing countries, where budget constraints frequently collide with systemic issues like the digital divide, a shortage of human resources, and poor infrastructure, this research is essential. Libraries in developing countries like Indonesia and Malaysia, which have complicated socioeconomic dynamics, serve as both information hubs and change agents by promoting literacy, educational situation, and fair access to information (Bradley, 2016)

Space Limitations

One of the most significant challenges confronting academic libraries is the limited space for collections management and for where collections are accessed for use. Limited shelf space,

insufficient storage, and all create organizational and access issues for library users. Meena & Lib (2024b) emphasized that managing space is a significant reason library engage in weeding and deselecting collections. As collections are constantly growing, libraries often have limited shelf space and cannot make available new materials or provide comfortable places of study for their patrons. Space limitations were also a pertinent issue in the public library (Rowley & Willson, 2022), as usable and accessible space was limited when the shelves were overcrowded. Space limitations therefore were significant considerations when operationalizing policy and practices for collection management.

Space limitations necessitate weeding and deselection projects in practice. As Adams and colleagues (2020) observe, libraries with large print collections will have limited available shelf space, creating the need for planning and data-driven choices of materials in the collection retain or deselect. DeMars and researchers (2019) investigate and showcase how large deselection projects can free up considerable shelf space for new collections or collaborative study areas, presenting a concrete example of the physical change through spatial management.

The factor of space also has ramifications for weeding and deselection mandates and policies. In parallel, (Acheson, 2024) cites the example of smaller library spaces imposing stricter weeding guidelines and follow-up policies because of the available space in the facility. This demonstrates how a small physical space requires deselection, to have the collection sustainable, accessible, and current. Furthermore, Proctor (2021) mentions that at Penn State University, the available shelving capacity had been exceeded, and no offsite storage was available; a systematic and methodical weeding project began. The library was reclaiming space; there were explicit deselection policies, library users were serviced at the appropriate access level, and the library was starting to think through sustainability through growth.

Libraries provide management of their collections that is both effective and environmentally responsible; they update their collections through inclusion of new, timely resources; and libraries use effective management of space/junctions within the library to enhance patron experience in meaningful ways. To put it another way, effective management of space/junctions is critical to the library's ability to effectively manage operations and provide for the academic needs of students at the college, and to be able to manage an up-to-date and relevant collection.

Staff Resistances

Staff Resistance Staff resistance specifically refers to the hesitance, reluctance, or discordance of staff in relation to the selection of materials to be removed from a collection. This resistance may be based on emotional attachments to books, a fear of judgment, lack of training, or ambiguity regarding if or how the staff should engage in weeding, or de-selection criteria for material. According to Prosser (2020) many librarians feel an extreme emotional attachment to books and to physical collections, which may prevent them from withdrawing materials that occupy a part of their professional identity and/or contribute to the professional identity of a library staff member. Similarly, (Broadbent et al., 2022) indicated that feelings of mistrust and staff refusal may manifest as a result of no communication about resource decisions regarding weeding or de-selection of materials. Staff particularly expressed refusal when there was a lack of information about the purpose for weeding or de-selection, or the criteria relevant to that decision.

Each aspect of internal conflict and organizational culture plays a significant role in shaping staff perspectives. Hallam and researchers (2021b) found that some librarians can be cynical about weeding because the process is framed as an easing of administrative burden to free up library space rather than as a way to increase the collection's relevance. In a similar vein, Burke

& Kilb (2019) noted that a lack of clarity, processes, or consistency in the practice of deselection processes contributed to confusion and uncertainty. Librarians who feel uncertain in the parameters that guide collection management are likely to stall participation in collection processes or not deselect at all.

Prior studies have also suggested that staff resistance is due in part to workload, understaffing, and a lack of institutional support. Bull & Downey 2024b) noted that librarians often regard weeding as an additional activity instead of a regular ongoing responsibility, particularly when they do not have resources or time. They explained that any time deselection can be integrated into the work of librarians, it generally reduces opposition and makes deselection practices sustainable. Similarly, Nelson and colleagues (2020a) added that inadequate training and insufficient technical support led to hesitance from staff, and their study suggested that offering faculty development opportunities to further enhance training, along with a personalized tool to facilitate deselection, could allow librarians to engage in deselection with increased confidence.

In essence, staff resistance remains a critical barrier to effective weeding and deselection in academic libraries. Emotional attachment, lack of communication, unclear policies, and limited resources all contribute to staff hesitation. Addressing these issues requires strong leadership, transparent communication, adequate training, and collaborative decision-making. By promoting a supportive and inclusive work environment, libraries can reduce resistance and ensure that deselection becomes an accepted and sustainable part of collection management.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

This study recognizes the necessity of a theoretical context and grounds itself in two primary theories: Ranganathan's Five Laws of Library Science (1931) and the concept of User-Centered Design (1988). In this study, the researchers will use these two theories to analyze the weeding and deselection practices in academic libraries.

Five Laws of Library Science

Dr. Shiyali Ramamrita Ranganathan introduced the Five Laws of Library Science in 1931, establishing the principles that frame how a library should operate (Okogwu, 2017, as cited in Okogwu, 2021). (Ranganathan, 1931) argued that a library's collection must be beneficial, relevant, and responsive to changing user needs.

The First Law says, "Books are for use." This means that library's collection must be in use (Liman et al., 2022). This aligns with the concept of sustainability in library collection management, where outdated or unused materials are not discarded but instead donated, recycled, or shared with other schools or non-profit organizations. By repurposing books in this way, libraries ensure that their resources continue to serve a purpose, benefiting other communities (Ranganathan, 1931, as cited in Kamau & Elegwa, 2022).

The Second Law, "Every reader his/her book," which builds upon the first law, is also user-centric. It asserts that all have the right to access information (Right to Information Act of 2004, as cited in Vishwasrao, 2019). This law emphasizes that a library's collection should meet the needs of all users. While staff may resist weeding due to concerns about losing materials that could still be valuable in the future, weeding and deselection practices can be better accepted if they are based on clear criteria and guided by the principle of keeping materials that serve current user needs Ranganathan (1931).

Ranganathan's Third Law, "Every book has its reader," asserts that every book in the library should serve a specific purpose and meet the needs of its users (Noruzi, 2004; Koehler et al., 2000, as cited in Maina 2021). The First Law supports the assertion that libraries must address the weeding and deselection practices in their Collection Development Policies. Remove books that are no longer useful or contain outdated or irrelevant materials, making way for newer, more valuable materials that are actually serves in the library (Nelson et al., 2020b).

Ranganathan's Fourth Law states, "Save the time of the reader," which addresses space limitations by advocating the removal of outdated or irrelevant materials. Weeding helps free up physical space in the library, allowing for more efficient use of the available area. This process ensures that only valuable, current resources occupy the space, because library materials should be “discoverable, findable, and accessible" (Anderson et al., 2019, p. 11).

The fifth law is that "the library is a growing organism," which reflects the need for libraries to adapt over time while managing budget constraints, as this is a key component of that growth. The integration of technology, such as automated data-collection tools for usage patterns, helps libraries stay current with user needs and trends, ensuring the collection evolves to meet users’ changing needs (Chhetri P, 2023; Moustapha & Biogera Abubakar, 2023).

User-Centered Design

User-Centered Design (UCD), popularized by Don Norman's book in the 1980s book (Cen et al., 2023), that focuses on users' needs, behavior, and input to design systems and services (Salinas et al., 2020). In the context of library weeding and deselection, this aligns with librarians and faculty involvement in collaborative weeding and with a data-driven weeding strategy throughout the process. UCD ensures the outcome meets users' expectations (Rhanoui et al., 2022).

In combination, these theoretical viewpoints provide a holistic framework to discuss the weeding process in academic libraries.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

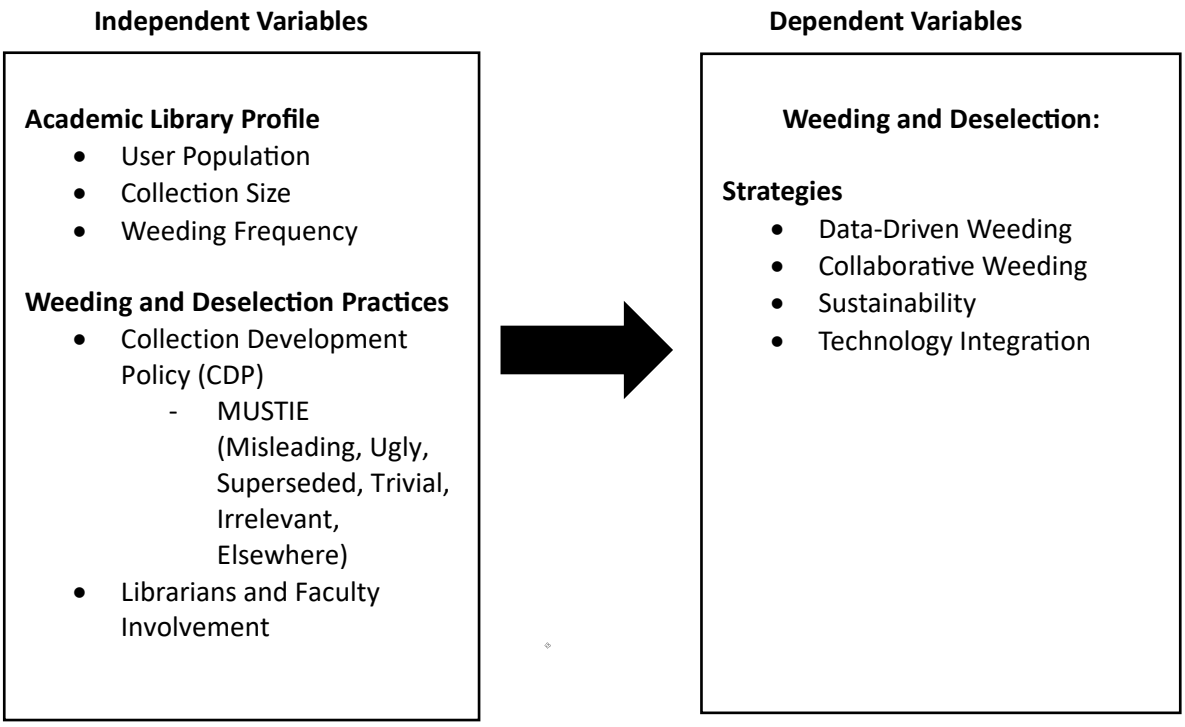


Figure 1. This Schematic Diagram shows the relationship between the independent and dependent variables of the study.

1.5 Statement of the Problem

Many academic libraries in the Philippines struggle to implement effective weeding and deselection due to budget constraints, space limitations, and staff resistance. While these challenges are common nationwide, libraries in the Caraga Region face additional, region-specific barriers. Despite the importance of weeding, academic libraries in the Caraga Region lack documented strategies and continue to face persistent challenges. This study seeks to address this gap by examining the challenges and strategies of libraries in the region. This study aims to address the following research questions.

1. What is the profile of the Academic Libraries in Caraga Region in terms of:
    1.1. User Population
    1.2. Collection Size
    1.3. Weeding Frequency
2. What are the weeding and deselection practices employed by academic libraries in Caraga Region in terms of:
    2.1. Collection Development Policy (CPD);
        2.1.1. MUSTIE;
    2.2. Librarians and Faculty Involvement?
3. What are the following strategies employed by academic libraries in the Weeding and Deselection process in terms of:
    3.1. Data-driven Weeding;
    3.2. Collaborative Weeding;
    3.3. Sustainability; and
    3.4. Technology Integration?

4. What are the challenges faced by academic libraries in implementing effective weeding and deselection processes in terms of:

   4.1. Budget Constraints;

   4.2. Space Limitations; and

   4.3. Staff Resistance?

5. Is there a significant relationship between the strategies and challenges of weeding and deselection practices in the academic libraries in Caraga region?

1.6 Hypotheses

Ho_1: there is a significant relationship between the strategies and challenges of weeding and deselection practices in the academic libraries in Caraga region?

1.7 Scope and Limitations

This study will examine the weeding and deselection practices currently employed by academic libraries in the Caraga Region. Particular attention will be given to the formulation and implementation of Collection Development Policies (CDP), the librarian and faculty involvement, the academic profile (user population, collection size, and weeding frequency), and the strategies such as data-driven weeding, collaborative weeding, sustainability, and technology integration. Furthermore, the study aims to identify and analyze the challenges these libraries face, including but not limited to budgetary constraints, space limitations, and staff resistance.

The scope of this research is deliberately confined to academic libraries operating within the Caraga Region. Libraries situated in other regions, as well as other types of libraries such as special, public, or school libraries, are excluded from consideration. The investigation is further delimited to practices in weeding and deselection and does not extend to other facets of library operations, including acquisition or selection processes.

1.8 Definition of Terms

Academic Library. It refers to college or university libraries within the Caraga Region that serve as the primary setting of this study on weeding and deselection practices.

Budget Constraints. It refers to the limited financial resources of academic libraries that affect their capacity to replace, update, or acquire new materials after weeding.

Caraga Region. It refers to Region XIII of the Philippines, composed of Agusan del Norte, Agusan del Sur, Surigao del Norte, Surigao del Sur, and Dinagat Islands, which serves as the study site.

Collaborative Weeding. It refers to a cooperative approach in which librarians, faculty, and administrators jointly evaluate and decide on materials to be removed from the collection.

Collection Development Policy (CDP). It refers to the written guideline used by academic libraries to select, acquire, and deselect materials during the weeding process.

Collection Management. It refers to the systematic process used by academic libraries in the Caraga Region to maintain, evaluate, and update their collections through weeding.

Collection Size. In this study, refers to the total volume of materials in the library's collection, which is regulated through weeding and deselection to maintain an updated, organized, and space-efficient collection that meets CHED standards.

Data-Driven Weeding. It refers to a weeding approach that relies on quantitative data, such as circulation records and publication dates, to determine which materials to remove.

Librarians and Faculty Involvement. It refers to the active participation of librarians and faculty members in evaluating and deciding which materials should be retained or weeded.

Space Limitation. It refers to the inadequate physical space in libraries that necessitates the removal of outdated or unused materials to accommodate new acquisitions.

Staff Resistance. It refers to the reluctance or opposition of library staff toward weeding activities due to emotional attachment or the fear that the resources might be needed in the future.

Sustainability. It refers to the environmentally conscious approach in weeding that promotes recycling, donating, or reusing weeded materials.

Technology Integration. It refers to the use of digital systems, databases, or software to enhance the efficiency and accuracy of the weeding and collection management process.

User Population. Refers to the individuals who use the library's resources and services, whose number, diversity, and usage patterns guide librarians in making informed weeding and deselection decisions.

Weeding and Deselection. Weeding refers to the process librarians use to evaluate and remove outdated, damaged, or irrelevant materials from the collection, which is also known as "deselection," the process of withdrawing or removing library materials based on specific criteria such as age, condition, usage, and relevance, as used in this study.

Weeding Frequency. In this study, it refers to how regularly librarians evaluate and remove outdated, damaged, or rarely used materials to keep the collection current, relevant, and responsive to users' needs.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter represents the research design, the research materials and methods, Environment, population and sample, and the ethical standards that will be used in this research study.

2.1 Research Design

This study will employ a quantitative descriptive-correlational research design, which is considered suitable for examining the relationships among weed management practices, strategies, and challenges. The quantitative approach facilitates the collection of measurable data, enabling statistical analysis and the identification of patterns and relationships within the population under study (Scoulas & De Groote, 2019).

The descriptive aspect of the research design seeks to ascertain the prevailing weeding and deselection practices within academic libraries, such as the formulation of collection development policies and the involvement of librarians and faculty members. In contrast, the correlational component aims to determine the extent to which these practices are associated with strategies intended to enhance the weeding process, including data-driven and collaborative approaches, sustainability considerations, and the integration of technology. The effectiveness of this research design in the field of library and information science has been demonstrated through case studies, such as those by Kamau & Elegwa (2022b), which offer comprehensive insights into resource management and collection development within libraries.

2.2 Research Materials and Methods

This study will employ a modified survey questionnaire from the instrument developed by Etuk and Adeyoyin (2021) in their research study, *"Analysis of Collection Development and Conservation of Information Resources in Selected University Libraries in Lagos and Ogun States,*

Nigeria". To examine the existence of the academic library's Collection Development Policy in the Caraga Region. This study will also employ the research instrument by Rowley (2017), entitled "*Public Libraries: Thoughts on Deselection*," for the MUSTIE criteria and academic library profile, focusing on the population and collection size. Additionally, this study will employ Dilevko and Gottlieb (2003) in their work, *"Weed to achieve: a fundamental part of the public library mission?"* Their questionnaire was designed to evaluate the involvement of librarians and faculty in weeding, the range of factors associated with weeding practices, such as the existence of data-driven weeding, collaborative weeding, sustainability, and the integration of technology within the weeding process. Furthermore, it addressed the various challenges encountered during weeding, including budgetary constraints, limited physical space, and staff resistance.

Part I assesses the academic library profile, focusing on key characteristics such as population, collection size, and weeding frequency. These factors are crucial for understanding how libraries manage their collections and the resources available for weeding and deselection.

Part II is devoted to an assessment of current weeding and deselection practices in libraries, with particular emphasis on the presence and effectiveness of collection development policies, as well as the degree of participation by both librarians and faculty members in these processes.

Part III examines the strategies employed during the weeding process, including data-driven approaches, the extent of stakeholder collaboration, the incorporation of sustainability principles, and the application of technological tools to facilitate effective weeding.

Part IV concerns identifying and analyzing the challenges libraries encounter during weeding, including financial limitations, space constraints, and staff opposition or reluctance.

All items will be rated on a 4-point Likert scale: Strongly Agree (4), Agree (3), Disagree (2), and Never (1).

Table 1: Shows the scale description of the survey questionnaire of the study

Scale	Verbal Description	Score Range (Quantitative Value)
4	Strongly Agree	3.25 – 4.0 (High)
3	Agree	2.50 – 3.24 (Average)
2	Disagree	1.75 – 2.49 (Low)
1	Never	1.00 – 1.74 (Very Low)

2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample

This research study is situated within academic libraries in the Caraga Region, an area of considerable significance to the Philippine Librarians Association, Inc. (PLAI), which serves as the national body for library professionals in the country. The Caraga Region is recognized for its dynamic and expanding library community, which plays a vital role in the ongoing advancement of the library profession at the local and national levels. Through its active engagement in Caraga, PLAI demonstrates its commitment to supporting libraries and library professionals across the Philippines, thereby contributing to the holistic development of the profession nationwide.

Caraga Region, comprising the two provinces of Surigao, the northern portion of Davao Oriental, and Eastern Misamis Oriental, was inhabited by the "Kalagans," also known as "Caravans" by the Spaniards. Later, the two Agusan Provinces were merged under Surigao's administrative control to become the autonomous Agusan Province, established in 1914. Surigao was split into Norte and Sur in 1960, while Agusan did the same in June 1967. In the 1950s, the logging boom brought businesspeople to Butuan, which was then merely an Agusan town. By Republic Act 523, the City Charter of Butuan was ratified on August 2, 1950.

The most recent region established by Republic Act No. 7901, authorized on February 23, 1995, is Region XIII, also known as the Caraga Administrative Region. Agusan del Norte, Agusan del Sur, Surigao del Norte, and Surigao del Sur make up this region. Surigao and Butuan are their capital cities.

The Caraga Region comprises five provinces: Agusan del Norte, Agusan del Sur, Surigao del Norte, Surigao del Sur, and the Province of Dinagat Islands. In addition to these provinces, the region includes one highly urbanized city, Butuan City, as well as five component cities: Bayugan City, Bislig City, Cabadbaran City, Surigao City, and Tandag City.

The respondents for this study shall be librarians/faculty members from academic libraries within the Caraga Region. The researchers have adopted the purposive sampling technique to represent academic libraries in the Caraga Region. A total of twenty-seven (27) respondents, with nineteen (19) from private institutions and eight (8) from public institutions. These respondents account for 70.37% of private libraries and 29.63% of public libraries.

Table 1: Shows the respondents of this study

Academic Libraries in Caraga Region	Population (F)	Percentage %
Private	19	70.37
Public	8	29.63
Total	27	100

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

Before identifying the respondents, the researchers will prepare two formal letters. The first letter was a request letter asking for the list of libraries in the Caraga Region. The second letter was a permission letter granting the researchers permission to conduct the study in the selected academic libraries. Both letters will be reviewed, checked, and approved by the

researchers' research adviser and subject instructor to ensure correctness and proper format before being distributed.

After the approval of the letters, the researchers will coordinate with the PLAI–Caraga Region Librarians Council to request the official list of libraries in the region. The researchers will then contact the head librarians or the librarians from each selected institution. Communication will be conducted via email and, when needed, via Facebook to ensure the message is received. The purpose of the study was explained, along with the request to participate. A Google Form will be provided to confirm participation. The form will ask the respondent to state the name of the institution and the library, and to answer 'yes' or 'no' to indicate their willingness to participate in the study.

The study will use a Quantitative Descriptive-Correlational Research Design. This research design is suitable for describing the weeding and deselection practices in academic libraries in the Caraga Region. It also allows the researchers to identify whether there are relationships between the library profile and the implementation of weeding and deselection practices.

The researchers will analyze and interpret the data using these tools:

Frequency and Percentage Distribution: This will be used to describe the academic library profile, including the population size, collection size, and weeding frequency across the academic libraries in the Caraga Region. It will also be used to categorize responses regarding librarian and faculty involvement in weeding and the challenges faced by libraries, such as budget constraints, limited space, and staff resistance.

Weighted Mean: This will assess the extent of involvement of librarians and faculty in weeding practices, as well as the perceived effectiveness of strategies such as data-driven weeding, collaborative weeding, and the integration of technology in the weeding process.

Pearson's Product-Moment Correlation: This will analyze the relationship between the academic library profile (population size, collection size, and weeding frequency) and the effectiveness of weeding practices, including the factors of librarian and faculty involvement, and the challenges faced by the libraries (e.g., budget constraints, space limitations, and staff resistance).

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

Through research protocols, the researchers will comply with the guidelines.

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

This research does not involve the creation of new technologies, processes, or products that would require patent protection. Additionally, no original materials such as reports or surveys will need copyright protection, nor is there any unique brand, logo, or symbol being created that would require trademark protection.

B. Informed Consent

Participants in this study, specifically librarians and faculty members, will be fully informed about the study's purpose, procedures, risks, and benefits through an informed consent form to understand the nature of their involvement. Libraries will first complete a brief screening form to determine eligibility for the study. At the end of the form, participants will be asked to confirm their consent to participate by selecting 'Yes' or 'No.' By selecting 'Yes,' participants consent to voluntarily participate in the study, understanding that their involvement is completely voluntary and they may withdraw at any time without consequence. Participants will also be informed of their right to withdraw from the study at any time without any consequences or impact on their professional standing. To ensure privacy, confidentiality and anonymity of participants will be strictly maintained throughout the study. All personal information will be securely stored and will not be shared without consent. The consent form is written in accessible language to ensure

understanding. Since the study does not involve animal or living organism trials, no additional ethical approval for animal welfare is required.

B. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

Personal or sensitive data collected from participants will be anonymized to protect their privacy. The data will be securely stored on encrypted platforms such as Google Drive, with access restricted to the researcher and authorized personnel. The data will not be shared with third parties, and if any data sharing is necessary, explicit consent from participants will be obtained beforehand.

D. Voluntary Participation

Participation in the study is entirely voluntary. Participants will be informed of their right to withdraw from the study at any point without any negative consequences. As the study does not involve animals, no ethical concerns regarding animal trials are relevant here.

E. Minimization of Harm

The study poses minimal risk to participants, as it involves answering a survey on library practices. No physical, psychological, or emotional harm is expected. However, if any distress occurs during participation, support services will be made available to participants. Ethical treatment of participants will be prioritized throughout the study.

F. Beneficence

The study contributes positively to the academic community by providing insights into improving weeding and deselection practices in academic libraries. The findings will help enhance library services and resource management. Participants will also have the option to request the research results once the study is completed.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

Participants will be selected based on fair and transparent criteria, ensuring that the selection process is inclusive and does not discriminate. The study will aim to include a diverse range of academic libraries from the Caraga Region, ensuring broad representation from different types of institutions.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

Standardized methods will be used to collect and analyze data to ensure the accuracy and reliability of the results. Potential biases, errors, and limitations of the study will be documented and addressed during the analysis phase to maintain the integrity of the data.

I. Transparency in Reporting

The findings of the study will be reported truthfully and transparently, ensuring that all data is presented without manipulation. Any copyrighted or patented materials used in the research will be properly cited and acknowledged in the final report.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

This study does not involve the use of patented technologies or copyrighted materials that require special clearance. Any materials referenced in the research will be properly cited according to academic standards.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

As this study involves human participants only, they will be informed of all potential risks and benefits associated with participation in the survey. Ethical approval has been obtained for the use of human participants, and the study will adhere to all ethical standards for human research.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies

This study will not employ AI or related technologies in data collection or analysis. However, Grammarly, an AI-assisted writing tool, will be used for grammar and style checks during

the preparation of this research. If future research incorporates other AI technologies, their use will be carefully managed to ensure the integrity of the data and prevent any misuse.

M. Ethical Approval

Ethical approval for this study will be obtained from the institution's ethics review board prior to data collection. The approval will ensure that all ethical guidelines are followed throughout the research process.

CHAPTER 3

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

3.1 Presentation and Analysis of Data

3.2 Proposed Intervention/ Output

CHAPTER 4

SUMMARY, CONCLUSION, RECOMMENDATION,

4.1. Summary

4.2. Conclusion

4.3.Recommendation

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CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: MARIDELLE C. GAITERA
ADDRESS: P-8, New Bohol, Sangay, Buenavista Agusan del Norte
EMAIL: maridelle_gaitera@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex	:	female
Date of birth	:	January 24, 2005
Height	:	5'0
Weight	:	43 kg.
Civil Status	:	single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : New Bohol Elementary High School
Secondary : Sangay National High School
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
none	**none**

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: ELLA JANE ESTANOL
ADDRESS: P-1 GUINABSAN BUENAVISTA, AGUSAN DEL NORTE
EMAIL: ellajane_estañol@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex	:	female
Date of birth	:	December 31, 2003
Height	:	5’0
Weight	:	51kg.
Civil Status	:	single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Tanutao Elementary School
Secondary : Guinabsan National High School
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
FLISS	**Muse**

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: KRISHA MAE G. SALE
ADDRESS: P-3, Sangay, Buenavista Agusan del Norte
EMAIL: krishamae_sale@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex	:	female
Date of birth	:	January 12, 2005
Height	:	5'2
Weight	:	51kg.
Civil Status	:	single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : New Bohol Elementary School
Secondary : Sangay National High School
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
none	**none**

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: OWEN JESSIER SENADOS
ADDRESS: District 2 Magkono Talisay, Nasipit Agusan Del Norte
EMAIL: owenjessier_senados@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex	:	male
Date of birth	:	April 8, 2003
Height	:	5'2
Weight	:	55kg.
Civil Status	:	single

Educational Attainment

Elementary : Tablon Elementary School
Secondary : Puerto National High School
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
SMCC CCIS LSG	1st year BLIS Representative 2023-2024
FLISS	Treasurer 2023-2025
FLISS	P.I.O 2024-2026
SMCC ESG College Department	2nd Year Representative 2024-2025
SMCC ESG College Department	Representative 2025-2026

CURRICULUM VITAE



NAME: RHEA MAE SALE
ADDRESS: P-3, Sangay, Buenavista Agusan del Norte
EMAIL: rheamae_sale@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Personal Information

Sex	:	female
Date of birth	:	November 27, 2004
Height	:	5’2
Weight	:	44kg.
Civil Status	:	single

Educational Attainment

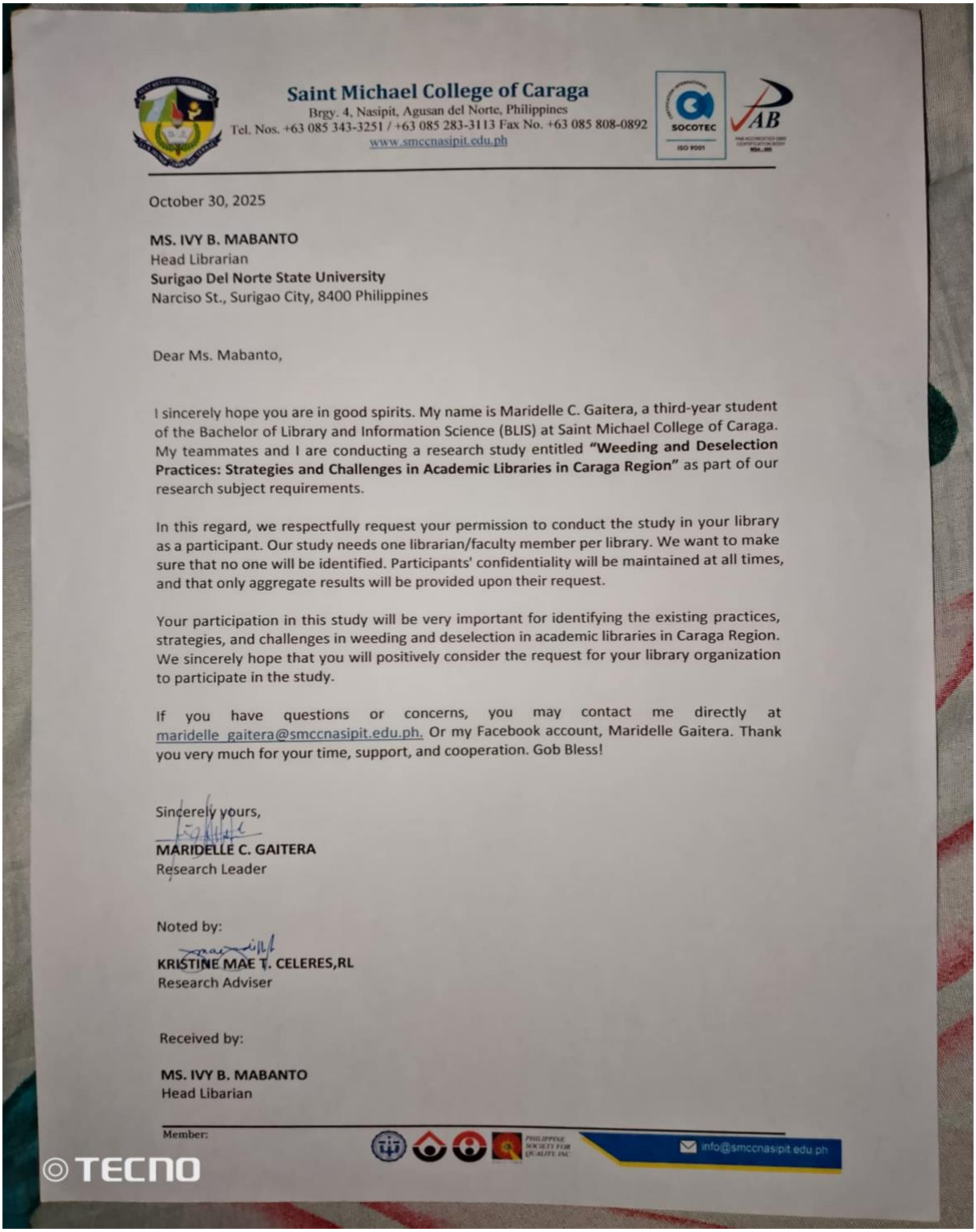
Elementary : Sangay Elementary School
Secondary : Sangay National High School
Tertiary : Saint Michael College of Caraga

Membership/Affiliations

ORGANIZATION	POSITIONS HELD
FLISS	**PIO**

APPENDICES

A - Letter of Approval with Certificate of Appearance and Photo



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Brgy. 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, Philippines
Tel. Nos. +63 085 343-3251 / +63 085 283-3113 Fax No. +63 085 808-0892
www.smccnasipit.edu.ph

October 30, 2025

MS. IVY B. MABANTO
Head Librarian
Surigao Del Norte State University
Narciso St., Surigao City, 8400 Philippines

Dear Ms. Mabanto,

I sincerely hope you are in good spirits. My name is Maridelle C. Gaitera, a third-year student of the Bachelor of Library and Information Science (BLIS) at Saint Michael College of Caraga. My teammates and I are conducting a research study entitled **"Weeding and Deselection Practices: Strategies and Challenges in Academic Libraries in Caraga Region"** as part of our research subject requirements.

In this regard, we respectfully request your permission to conduct the study in your library as a participant. Our study needs one librarian/faculty member per library. We want to make sure that no one will be identified. Participants' confidentiality will be maintained at all times, and that only aggregate results will be provided upon their request.

Your participation in this study will be very important for identifying the existing practices, strategies, and challenges in weeding and deselection in academic libraries in Caraga Region. We sincerely hope that you will positively consider the request for your library organization to participate in the study.

If you have questions or concerns, you may contact me directly at maridelle_gaitera@smccnasipit.edu.ph. Or my Facebook account, Maridelle Gaitera. Thank you very much for your time, support, and cooperation. Gob Bless!

Sincerely yours,

MARIDELLE C. GAITERA
Research Leader

Noted by:

KRISTINE MAE T. CELERES,RL
Research Adviser

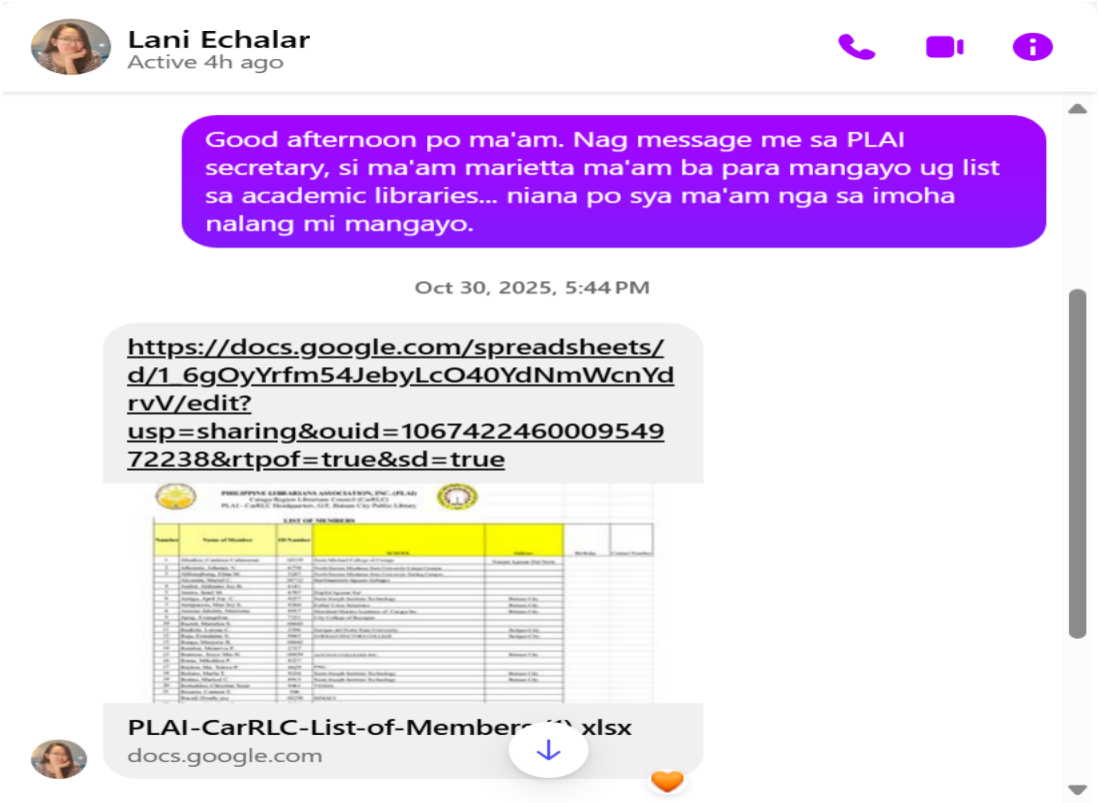
Received by:

MS. IVY B. MABANTO
Head Libarian

Member:

info@smccnasipit.edu.ph

Requesting the list of academic libraries in the Caraga Region



B - Instrument with Informed Consent

Rating Scale	Verbal Description	Verbal Interpretation
1	Strongly Agree	This means that the statement is always true to me.
2	Agree	This means that the statement is often true to me.
3	Disagree	This means that the statement is sometimes true to me.
4	Never	This means that the statement is not true to me.

Part I: Academic Library Profile

1. **Academic Libraries Profile**
   What is the user population of your Academic Library?
   (Please select the appropriate range)
   - **A. Population**
     - ☐ less than 10,000
     - ☐ 10,001-50,000
     - ☐ 50,001-100,000
     - ☐ 100,001-500,000
     - ☐ more than 500,000
     - ☐ Unsure
   - **B. Collection Size**
     What is the collection size of your Academic Library?
     (Please select the appropriate range)
     - ☐ Fewer than 10,000
     - ☐ 10,001 – 50,000
     - ☐ 50,000 – 100,000
     - ☐ 100,001 – 500,000
     - ☐ 500,001 – 1,000,000
     - ☐ More than 1,000,000
     - ☐ Not sure
   - **C. Weeding Frequency**
     How often does your library implement weeding?
     (Please select the appropriate range)
     - ☐ Irregular (when needed)
     - ☐ Ongoing (continuous)
     - ☐ Yearly
     - ☐ Every two years
     - ☐ Monthly
     - ☐ Weekly or daily
     - ☐ Bi-annually
     - ☐ Every three years
     - ☐ Every five years
     - ☐ Every four years

Part II: Weeding and Deselection Practices

2. What are the weeding and deselection practices employed by academic libraries in Caraga Region?

Collection Development Policy	Strongly Agree (4)	Agree (3)	Disagree (2)	Never (1)
1. Our library follows any written guidelines for weeding the print material of the general book collection of our library.				
2. I believe that written policies are needed.				
3. I believe that the Collection Development Policy (CDP) supports our library decisions to remove materials from the collection.				
4. The Collection Development Policy in my library is reviewed and revised periodically.				
5. There is a Collection Development Policy in our library.				
6. Our Collection Development Policy addresses the Deselection process with MUSTIE criteria:				
M = MISLEADING *(and/or factually inaccurate)*				
7. Our library removes materials from the collection if they are factually incorrect.				
8. Our library removes materials that are unacceptable stereotypes or sexist terminology.				
9. Our library removes items based on the accuracy of information contained in the item.				
U = UGLY *(worn out and beyond mending or rebinding)*				
10. Our library removes materials in poor condition or those that are physically damaged.				
S = SUPERSEDED (*by a truly new edition or by a much better book on the subject)*				
11. Our library removes materials that have been superseded by newer resources.				
12. Our library removes out-of-print materials.				
13. Our library removes materials that are duplicated.				
14. Our library removes materials when other books on the same topic are more current or of better quality.				

T = TRIVIAL *(of no discernible literary or scientific merit; usually of ephemeral interest at some time in the past)*				
15. Our library removes items that are sexist or racist.				
16. Our library removes unacceptable stereotypes.				
17. Our library removes politically inappropriate materials.				
18. Our library remove materials has low circulation rate.				
I = IRRELEVANT *(irrelevant to the needs and interests of the community)*				
19. Our library removes materials that no longer align with the library's mission.				
20. Our library removes materials that no longer meet the needs of our users.				
21. Our library removes materials that are beyond the collection scope of the library.				
E = EASILY OBTAINED ELSEWHERE *(The material or information may be obtained expeditiously elsewhere through interlibrary loan, reciprocal borrowing, or in electronic format)*				
22. Our library removes materials that are available through inter-library loan.				
23. Our library removes materials when the content is available in another format (e.g., audiobooks, CDs, and public access computers).				
Librarians and Faculty Involvement				
1. In our library, the faculty members assist librarians in knowing what materials to remove.				
2. In our library, the faculty members review material that has been designated for weeding before the final decision.				
3. In our library, the weeding process involves a team of librarians and staff members.				
4. In our library, the final decision on weeding materials is made by a high-level librarian (e.g., Director or Head Librarian).				
5. I believe that faculty members should be more involved in the weeding process in our library.				

Part III: Weeding and Deselection Strategies

3. What are the strategies employed by academic libraries to improve the weeding and deselection process?

Data-driven Weeding	Strongly Agree (4)	Agree (3)	Disagree (2)	Never (1)
1. In our library, librarians are determining which books should be weeded based on criteria.				
2. In our library, the age of the item is used as a criterion for weeding.				
3. In my library, items with low circulation are weeded from the collection.				
4. In our library, duplicated items are removed from the collection as part of the weeding process.				
5. I believe that the use of circulation data helps ensure that weeding decisions are made based on actual usage rather than assumptions.				
Collaborative Weeding				
1. I believe that more staff are needed to help weed.				
2. I believe that weeding teams are needed to save time.				
3. Weeding in our library involves multiple staff members in a team-based approach.				
4. In our library, higher-level administrators, such as the Head Librarian or Director, make the final decision on weeded materials.				
5. In our library, community members or external experts are consulted before making final decisions on weeding materials.				
Sustainability				
1. After weeding, materials go to the storage room.				
2. After weeding, we donate the items.				
3. After weeding, we give to other libraries.				
4. After weeding, we sell, then recycle the rest.				
5. After weeding, we sell, then throw away the rest.				
6. After weeding, we give items away free to the public.				
Technology Integration				

1. I believe that automation is necessary to improve weeding procedures.				
2. I believe that the use of automated systems to generate weed lists makes the process easy.				
3. I believe weeding helps create space for emerging technologies, such as public access computers and digital resources.				
4. Our library uses automated systems to help identify low-circulating materials for weeding.				
5. Our library uses handheld scanners to assist in the weeding process.				

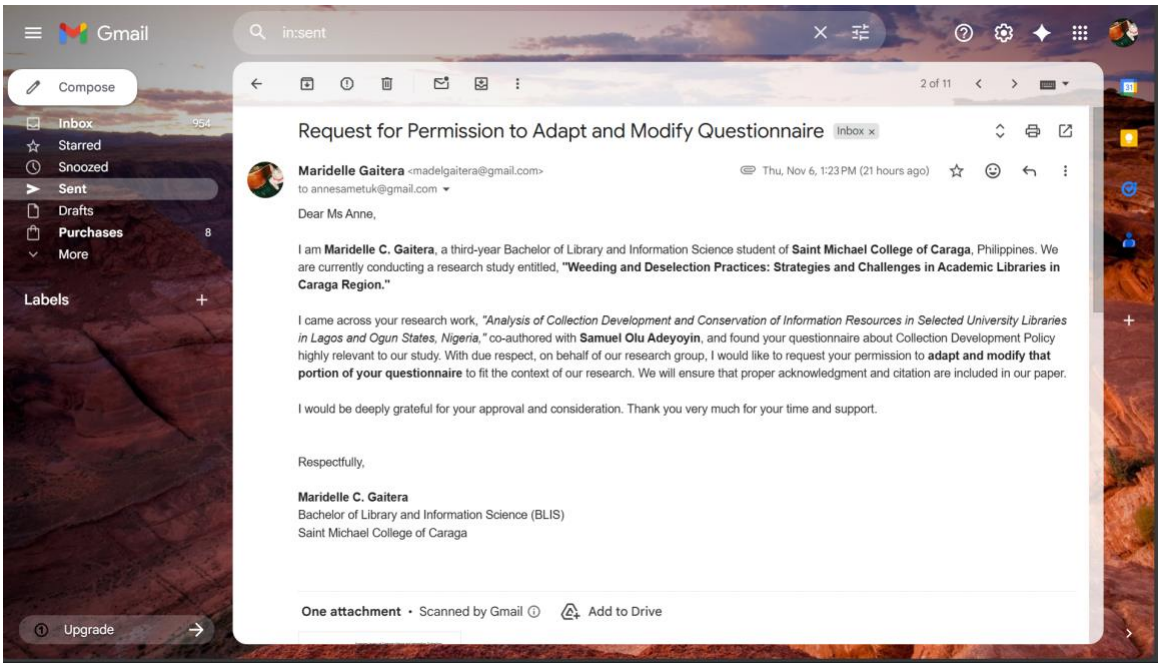
Part IV: Weeding and Deselection Challenges

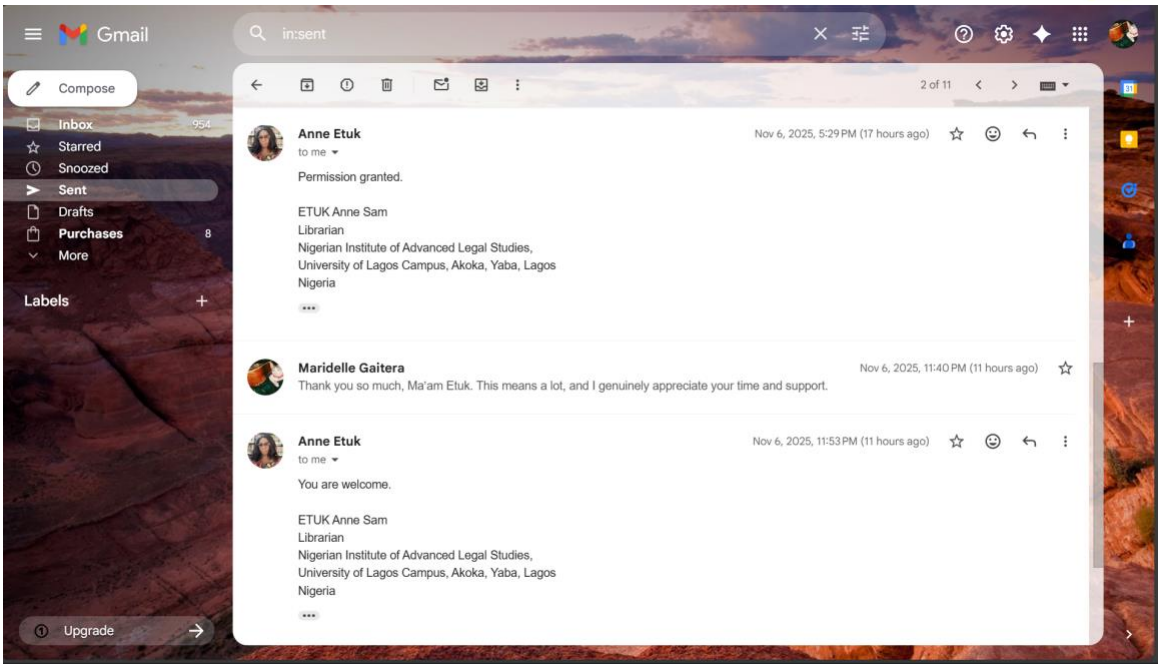
4. What are the challenges faced by academic libraries in implementing effective weeding and deselection processes?

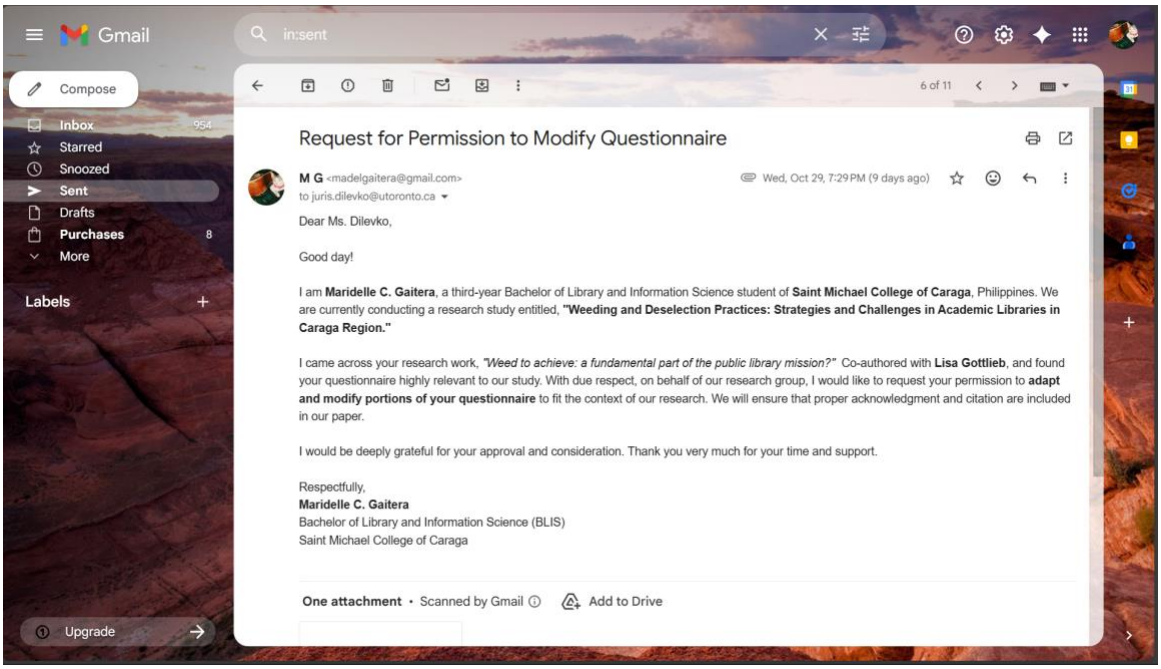
Budget Constraints	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Never (1)**
1. I am reluctant to weed due to a lack of funding to replace weeded books.				
2. I believe that a bigger budget is necessary for the wedding.				
3. I believe that more financial resources should be allocated to weeding activities in our library.				
4. I believe that Book Depot is needed externally to our library.				
5. I believe that budget constraints impact the ability of our library to weed and manage the collection effectively.				
Space Limitations				
1. I am reluctant to weed due to the lack of storage space available for weeded materials.				
2. I am reluctant to weed due to the lack of shelves for new collections to occupy.				
3. I believe that more storage space and storage shelves in our library are needed.				
4. I believe that weeding is necessary to make room for new technologies.				
5. I believe that the lack of shelf space is a significant challenge in managing our library's collection.				
Staff Resistance				

1. I am hesitant to weed due to fear that the item might be needed in the future.				
2. I am hesitant to weed out local history materials.				
3. I am hesitant to weed due to the materials being hard to replace.				
4. I am hesitant to weed due to the items being in high demand.				
5. I have personally saved a book or materials that should have been weeded.				

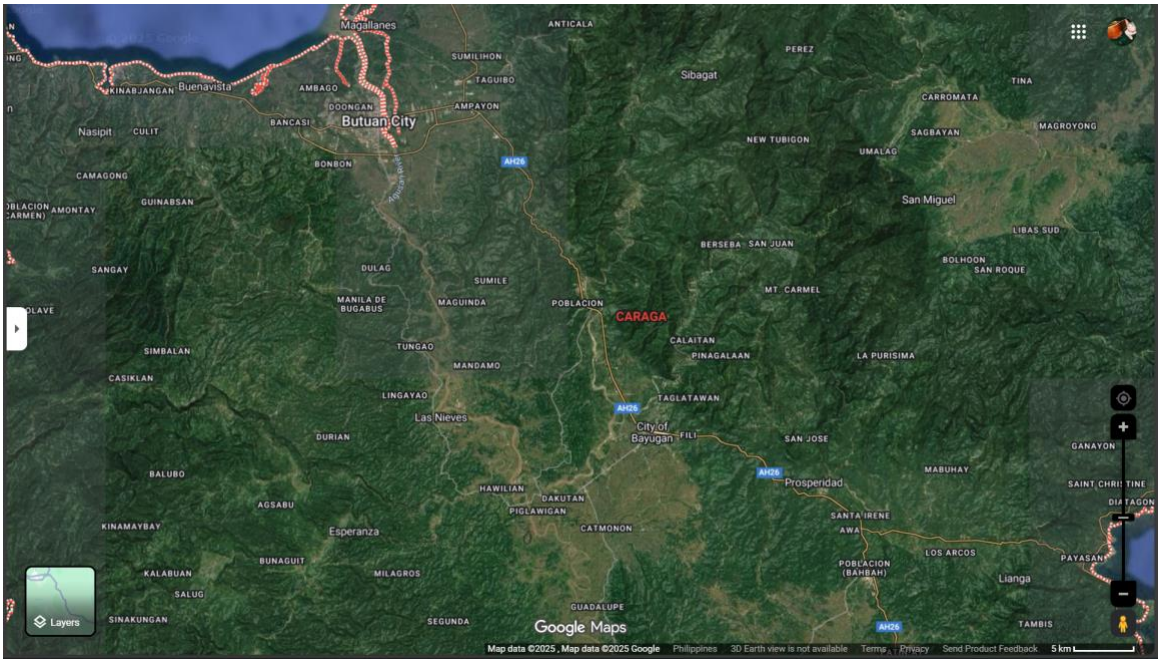
REQUESTING PERMISSION TO ADAPT AND MODIFY QUESTIONNAIRE




Gmail
in:sent
Compose
Inbox 954
Starred
Snoozed
Sent
Drafts
Purchases 8
More
Labels
Upgrade
2 of 11
Anne Etuk
to me
Nov 6, 2025, 5:29 PM (17 hours ago)
Permission granted.
ETUK Anne Sam
Librarian
Nigerian Institute of Advanced Legal Studies,
University of Lagos Campus, Akoka, Yaba, Lagos
Nigeria
Maridelle Gaitera
Nov 6, 2025, 11:40 PM (11 hours ago)
Thank you so much, Ma'am Etuk. This means a lot, and I genuinely appreciate your time and support.
Anne Etuk
to me
Nov 6, 2025, 11:53 PM (11 hours ago)
You are welcome.
ETUK Anne Sam
Librarian
Nigerian Institute of Advanced Legal Studies,
University of Lagos Campus, Akoka, Yaba, Lagos
Nigeria


Gmail
in:sent
Compose
Inbox 954
Starred
Snoozed
Sent
Drafts
Purchases 8
More
Labels
Upgrade
6 of 11
Request for Permission to Modify Questionnaire
M G <madelgaitera@gmail.com>
to juris.dilevko@utoronto.ca
Wed, Oct 29, 7:29 PM (9 days ago)
Dear Ms. Dilevko,
Good day!
I am Maridelle C. Gaitera, a third-year Bachelor of Library and Information Science student of Saint Michael College of Caraga, Philippines. We are currently conducting a research study entitled, "Weeding and Deselection Practices: Strategies and Challenges in Academic Libraries in Caraga Region."
I came across your research work, "Weed to achieve: a fundamental part of the public library mission?" Co-authored with Lisa Gottlieb, and found your questionnaire highly relevant to our study. With due respect, on behalf of our research group, I would like to request your permission to adapt and modify portions of your questionnaire to fit the context of our research. We will ensure that proper acknowledgment and citation are included in our paper.
I would be deeply grateful for your approval and consideration. Thank you very much for your time and support.
Respectfully,
Maridelle C. Gaitera
Bachelor of Library and Information Science (BLIS)
Saint Michael College of Caraga
One attachment • Scanned by Gmail
Add to Drive

C - Map of the Research Locale



8.805367601707308, 125.74021224608263

Source: https://maps.app.goo.gl/fnxNeuXLQNBhaMfj6

D- Narrative & Photo Documentation

On **10/29/25**, we met our research adviser, Ms. Kristine Mae T. Celeres. During this meeting, we presented our work on Chapter 2 and received valuable feedback.

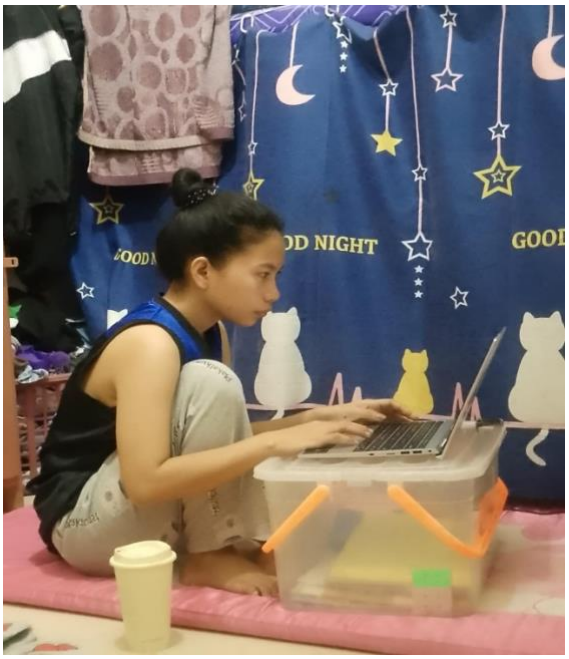


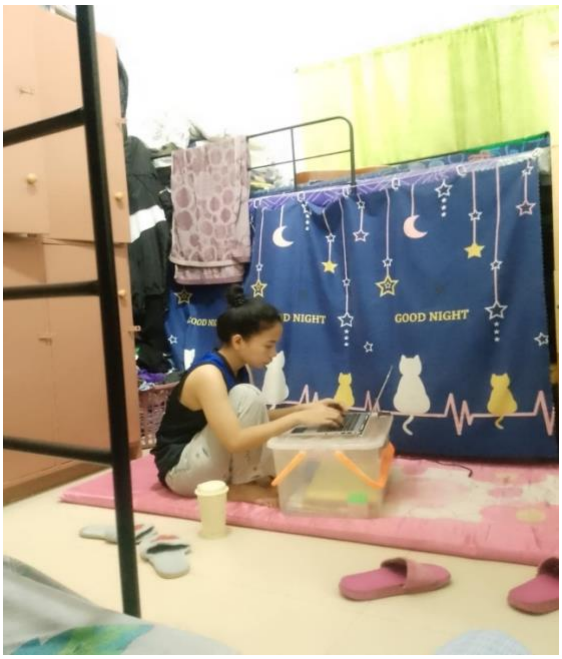


On **11/06/25**, we met with our research instructor, Mrs. Beverly Jaminal, to discuss our manuscript. We received valuable feedback on improving the Schematic Diagram and RRL.




THE TEAM





E- Ethics Committee Approval

CERTIFICATE OF TECHNOLOGY ASSESSMENT

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
Atupan St., Brgy. 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte 8602, Philippines
Website: www.smccnasipit.edu.ph : Tel. Nos. 085 300-2932

TEST RESULT
TECHNOLOGY-BASED QUALITY ASSURANCE

Date of Test	November 3, 2025	**Control number**	**RBLIS125004**	
Research Title	**Weeding and Deselection Practices: Strategies and Challenges in Academic Libraries in Caraga Region**			
Author (s)	1	Maridelle Gaitera	**ORCID No.**	0009-0000-5278-5960
	2	Krisha Mae G. Sale	**ORCID No.**	0009-0002-2552-0750
	3	Rhea Mae Sale	**ORCID No.**	0009-0006-2855-1033
	4	Owen Jessier Senados	**ORCID No.**	0009-0008-4396-2388
	5	Ella Jane Estanol	**ORCID No.**	0009-0002-9936-720X
Co-author (s)	1	Kristine Mae T. Celeres	**ORCID No.**	0000-0003-4641-4025

Contact Person	Maridelle Gaitera
Address	P-8, New Bohol, Sangay, Buenavista Agusan del Norte
Mobile Number	09652881489

Test subject	Chapters 1-2				
Total number of words	**8,881**	**Sentences**	**712**	**Characters**	**62,643**

	Test Area	Score	Required	Remarks
	(1) Plagiarism	**98**	**90%**	PASSED
	(2) Grammar	**98**	**95%**	PASSED
	(3) Readability Score	**27**	**25**	PASSED
	(4) AI Text	**20**	**40%**	PASSED
	(5) Reliability *(Test Instrument only)*	N/A	N/A	

FINDING(S) & RECOMMENDATION(S)

Evaluated by:	Approved by:
MICHELLE ANN G. LUCINO	**KENNETH IAN B. BARRERA, MA**
Signature over Printed Name	Head of Research

Member:

Email: communications@smccnasipit.edu.ph

CERTIFICATE OF AUTHENTIC AUTHORSHIP

This is to certify that I/we, the undersigned author(s), have solely and honestly written the entire paper titled: **"Weeding and Deselection Practices: Strategies and Challenges in Academic Libraries in Caraga Region."** All contents, ideas, data, and analysis presented in this paper are the results of my/our own diligent work and intellectual effort. The paper has been crafted to the best of my/our abilities, in full compliance with academic integrity standards and ethical research practices.

I/We further declare that:

1. This paper is free from any form of plagiarism or copyright infringement.
2. All referenced materials have been properly cited, and due credit has been given to the original authors and sources.
3. The work does not contain any falsified or fabricated data or information.

I/We acknowledge that if any rules or laws related to copyright, plagiarism, or other related legal or ethical standards are violated, Saint Michael College of Caraga shall not be held accountable for my/our actions. Any legal, academic, or ethical consequences arising from such violations shall solely be my/our responsibility.

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Date: _____
Location: _____

Author(s):

Maridelle Gaitera
Author

Ella Jane Estanol
Author

Krisha Mae Sale
Author

Owen Jessier Senados
Author

Rhea Mae Sale
Author